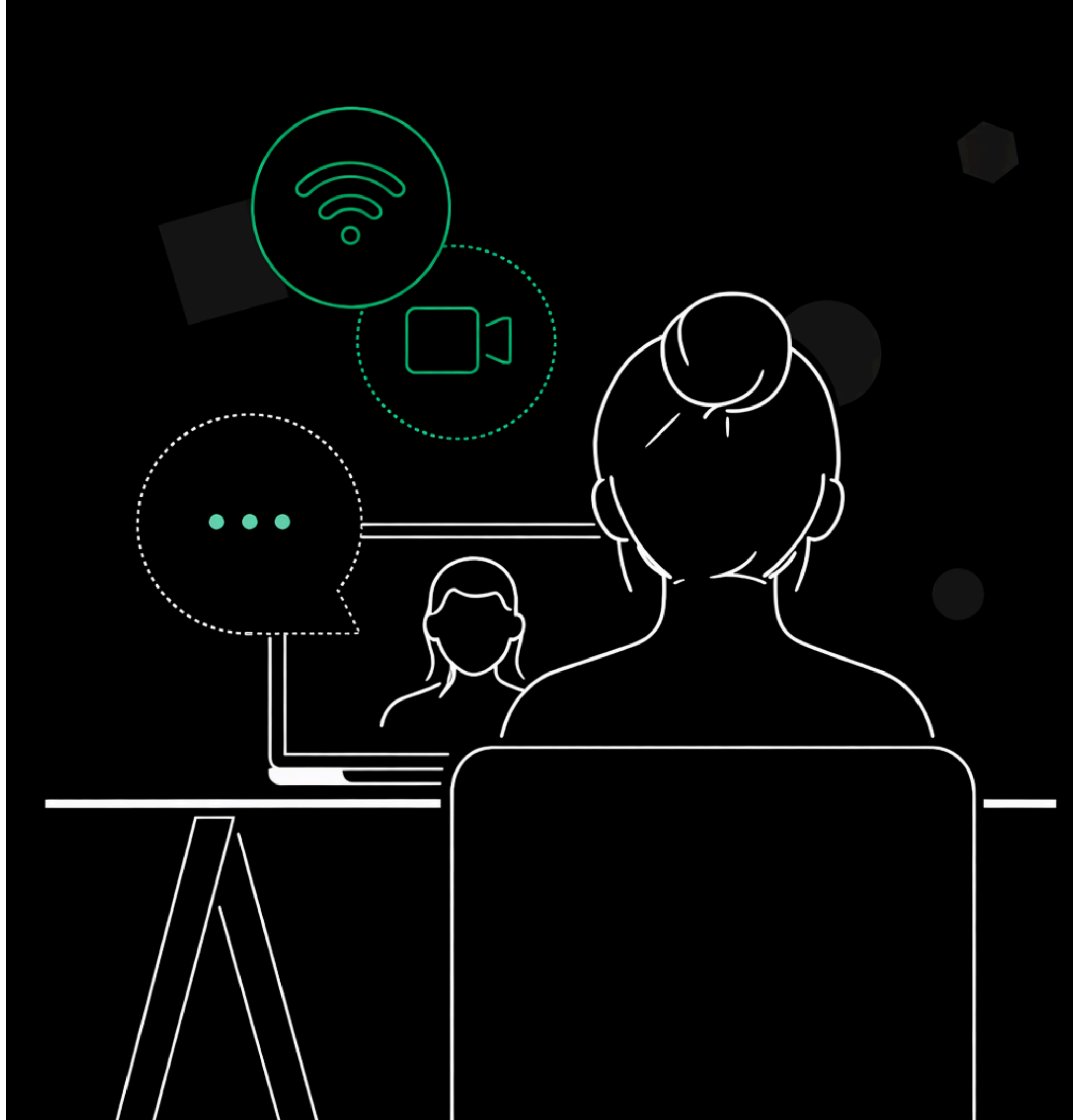


JS Job Surface

Interview Preparation Handbook

Get better at interviews with
simple tips and practical
advice that actually work.



The standard interview structure

- Icebreaker Talk

- Your Pitch

- Interview Stories

- Your Questions

- Closing Discussion



Prepare for Icebreaker Talk

**This usually happens at the beginning
of most interviews**



■ Icebreaker Talk

You can follow the interviewer's flow, or start the conversation yourself with something simple like:

- “Thanks for taking the time to speak with me today. I’ve gone through the job description and I’m excited to learn more about it.”
- “Hi, thanks for meeting with me. How’s your day going so far?”

Prepare for Your Pitch

“Tell me briefly about yourself.”

This is your chance to guide the conversation toward how your skills and experience match the role.



■ Your Pitch

Introduction Tips:

1. Start with what's **most relevant** to the role
2. Explain what **you do** and the **value** you bring
3. Share one strong **achievement**
4. Speak **clearly** rather than cleverly

PRO TIP!

Keep it under two minutes and highlight your growth

Prepare your Interview Stories

“Tell me more about your experience?”



■ Interview Stories

How it usually goes:

- The interviewer asks follow-up questions after discussing the project and role needs.
- A mix of **technical** and **behavioral** questions.
- They want to see both your **knowledge** and your real **experience** in similar work.

Prepare your Interview Stories

How do I prepare my talking points?



Before the interview

■ Interview Stories

STAR Model:

- **Situation:** What was the situation and the context you were working in?
- **Task:** What was the goal or responsibility you were expected to handle?
- **Action:** What exact steps did you take and what part did you personally own?
- **Result:** What was the outcome, what did you achieve, and what did you learn?

Prepare your Interview Stories

How do I prepare my talking points?



Before the interview

■ Interview Stories

STAR Model: REAL World Example

- **Situation:** Latency spikes occurred when HPA scaled pods during deployments in a production Kubernetes cluster.
- **Task:** Stop deployment-related latency without changing app code or adding nodes.
- **Action:** I traced delays to slow image pulls and readiness probes, tuned probe settings, optimized image caching, and adjusted HPA scale-up behavior. I handled the analysis and rollout.
- **Result:** Latency during deployments disappeared, rollouts stabilized, and I gained a clearer understanding of HPA and pod startup behavior.

Prepare your Interview Stories

How do I choose the right stories to share with the interviewer?



■ Interview Stories

What Works Best:

- Select examples that directly reflect the **skills, knowledge, and experience** the role requires.
- **Prepare to explain key projects** that best reflect your experience, using a clear structure.

Prepare questions for the Interviewers

Clarify what details about the role are important for you.



■ Your Questions

Top picks:

- Role and responsibilities questions
- Project and expectations questions
- Meetings and time tracking questions
- Team processes and ways of working questions

Closing the discussion

What do I say at the close of the interview?



■ Closing Discussion

My 2 cents:

- Final impressions matter
- Brief your final pitch
- Ask if any additional details are needed
- Thank them for their time and the opportunity
- Express interest and motivation to work with them



■ Before the Interview

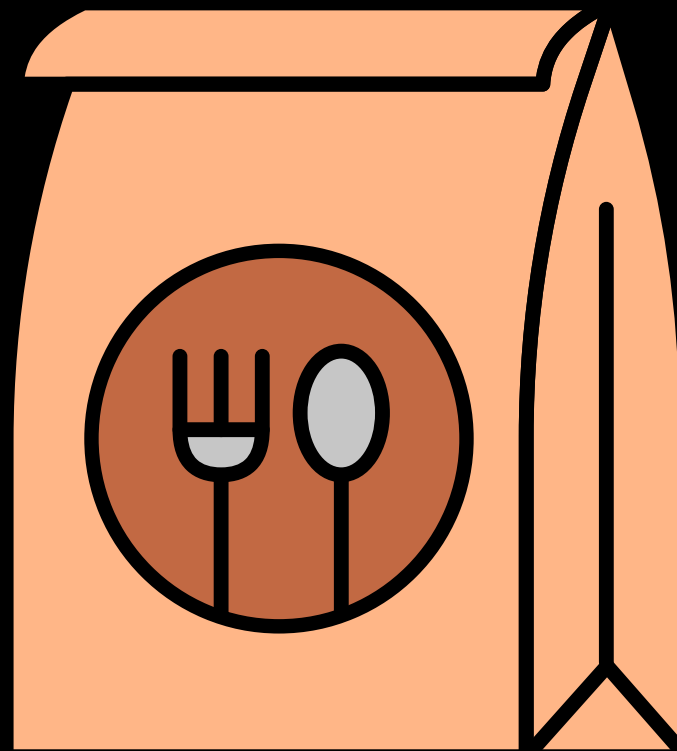
First impressions matter!

- ✓ Be ready to start on time
- ✓ Prepare STAR-structured examples
- ✓ Read the job description and note the skills and responsibilities being asked
- ✓ Check the company website to understand what they build, sell, or operate

■ During the Interview

- ✓ Be genuinely engaged and listen carefully
- ✓ Explain your thoughts, not just the answer
- ✓ Show your motivation for the role
- ✓ Share how you approach challenges

Key Takeaways



■ Key Takeaways

- ✓ Prepare for icebreaker talk and your introduction pitch
- ✓ Pick relevant stories that match what the interviewer is looking for
- ✓ Ask thoughtful questions to guide the discussion
- ✓ Listen carefully, stay engaged, and show interest in the role
- ✓ Share information clearly and step by step



Your Next Step

You've completed this guide. The next step is finding the right opportunities early.

You are now part of JobSurface. We continuously track DevOps and Cloud roles directly from company career pages. New opportunities that don't appear on LinkedIn or popular job boards are sent straight to your email.

You'll receive regular updates with newly discovered roles, so you can review them early and apply before they become crowded.